POTO ME PIPI

Episode 1

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TE ‘MEA’ O KORO, INĀ TE PŌKĪKĪ

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SERIES LOGLINE:
In the town of Tāpito, Pipi the brave ngeru and Poto the clever kurī, inspired by comic detective Matua Mātai, solve whimsical mysteries while teaching tamariki empathy, problem-solving, and te ao Māori values.

EPISODIC LOGLINE:
When Koro Tama loses his mysterious “mea,” Pipi and Poto channel their favourite detective, Matua Mātai, to solve the case—only to discover the importance of paying attention to the world (and loved ones) around them.

INT. KORO'S HOBBY ROOM - DAY

Koro Tama's bookshelf stands proudly in a dedicated room of his different hobbies and collections, such as shells, paintings, posters, carvings, and wooden trinkets.

In the bookshelf rests his prized collection of 'Matua Mātai' comics. The covers are slightly faded and the pages worn.

PIPI (7), an energetic ngeru bursts into the room, followed by POTO (7), a cautious and careful kurī.

Now at the bookshelf. Pipi excitedly scans the Matua Mātai comics, unsure of what to pick.

PIPI
Poto! AUE! Which one should we choose? There's so many!

PIPI
AUĒ e Poto! Ko tēhea hei pānuitanga mā tāua?

POTO
(while pointing at a comic)
How about this one?

POTO
(while pointing at a comic)
Pēhea oti tēnei nā?

PIPI
Hmmm nah.

PIPI
Hmmm kāhore.

POTO
You always get to pick!

POTO
E mara, ko koe ka kōwhiri i ngā wā katoa!

INSERT:

A weathered comic book cover. Decades old, corners bent and creased. The title reads: MATUA MĀTAI.

A Māori detective stands center, coat collar turned up, fedora pulled low. His eyes are sharp, knowing. Behind him, a city skyline wreathed in shadow.

BACK TO:

PIPI
Aha! The Kererū Clue! It has action, mystery- everything a good Matua Mātai story needs!

PIPI
Inā! "Te Tīwhiri Kererū". He paki mātātoa, porehu-katoa katoa e kīia ai he paki Matua Mātai!

POTO
I hope Koro stays awake this time. He had to make up the ending last time because he kept falling asleep.

POTO
Me kaha mai a Koro, kei moe anō ia. Nā tana kānewha i hangahanga noa ia i te mutunga o te pakiwaitara!

INSERT:

KORO TAMA (70s), sits in his armchair in the lounge snoring with a Mātua Mātai comic on his chest.

PIPI
KORO!

A massive SNORE.

BACK TO:

In the hobby room, Pipi extracts the comic like it's made of glass. It's as if she's handling a precious taonga.

POTO
Careful!

POTO
Ohh kia tika hoki.

PIPI
I am!

PIPI
E mara!

They make an exit.

POTO
Next time I get to choose.

POTO
Māku te pukapuka a kō ake.

Pipi laughs.

INT. KORO'S KITCHEN - DAY

The space is a mess; Koro Tama is a whirlwind of frantic energy, rummaging through drawers and muttering under his breath.

Pipi and Poto carefully walk in with the comic.

KORO TAMA
Argh, where's my thing?

KORO TAMA
Argh, kei hea taku mea?

PIPI AND POTO
(together)
We picked one! Can you read it to us now?

PIPI AND POTO
(together)
Koro, anei! Tēnā, pānuitia mai?

KORO TAMA
Not now moko.

KORO TAMA
Taihoa ake e āku moko.

PIPI AND POTO
(together and saddened)
Why?

PIPI AND POTO
I te aha ai?

KORO TAMA
I need my thingy so I can, y'kno. I need the thing for the thingy.

KORO TAMA
Ah, e kimi ana au i tāku mea. Tāku mea mō te mea rā.

Pipi and Poto look at each other confused. QUESTION MARKS pop up around their heads.

PIPI
What thing Koro?

PIPI
Tēhea mea e Koro?

Koro Tama twists his arms around his head and then makes strange gestures and shapes with his hands.

KORO TAMA
It's the thingy, I put inside the thing. So I can read the thing.

KORO TAMA
Argh, tāku mea. Kia meatia ake ai tāku mea ki tāku mea, e pai ai tāku pānui i tērā mea.

As Pipi and Poto's confusion deepens, more question marks appear around their heads.

Koro Tama is now on his hands and knees with his head in the cupboard looking around. His voice echoes.

KORO TAMA
(voice muffled in cupboard)
It's a mystery! Where is it!

KORO TAMA
Kua ngaro! Kei hea rā?

Pipi and Poto look at each other with glee!

PIPI AND POTO
A mystery!

PIPI AND POTO
He paki porehu!

PIPI
If it's that important we'll find it!

PIPI
Mā māua tō mea e kimi e Koro!

KORO TAMA
(still muffled)
If you find it, I'll read that thing.

KORO TAMA
Kāti, kia kitea, ka pānuitia e au tērā mea.

POTO
(Cautious)
Are you sure we're qualified for this?

POTO
E whakapono ana koe ka taea e tāua?

PIPI
We're Matua Mātai's biggest fans. We're over qualified!

PIPI
Āe mārika e mara! Ka taea e tāua - he apataki nā Matua Mātai!

Pipi zooms off. Poto slowly idles off.

POTO
It could be somewhere scary...

POTO
He mahi mōrearea hoki pea...

<u>MONTAGE:</u> DETECTIVE MODE ACTIVATED

- *They put their hats on.*
- *They put their oversized coats on.*
- *Pipi and Poto look through their magnifying glasses.*

- *They stand proudly next to each other, detective mode is on!*

END MONTAGE.

EXT. KORO'S GARDEN - PĀTAKA KAI - DAY

NOTE: *'Detective Mode' has a different aesthetic. The scenes and shot sizes, composition reflect classic (film noir) detective cinema. What has their attention has a blue glow like nature to it.*

We slowly push into the pātaka, a storehouse raised upon posts with a short ladder leading to the door.

INT. KORO'S GARDEN - PĀTAKA KAI / DETECTIVE ROOM - DAY

In their detective costumes they're deep into 'detective mode' and they've been at it a long time. The cork-board has become a chaotic masterpiece of desperation, littered with scraps of paper, various items and rough sketches.

PIPI
(adamant)
I'm sure he's looking for his favourite fishing hat!

PIPI
E kimi ana ia i tana tino pōtae hī ika!

Pipi points to a fishing hat drawing in crayon.

INSERT:

Pipi's imagination resembles a child's drawing. Koro Tama simply stands there wearing an incredibly old fishing hat against a plain white background.

CUT BACK TO:

POTO
(fed-up)
But why would he be rummaging through the kitchen for a fishing hat?

POTO
Engari he aha ia te kimi pōtae I te kīhini?

PIPI
Hats end up in weird places.

PIPI
Mmm, ka kitea he pōtae ahatia ki hea.

Close on a wooden spoon that's been taped to the cork-board.

POTO (O.S.)
What about Nan's carved wooden spoon!?

POTO (O.S.)
Pēhea oti te pune rākau a Karani Mā/Nan?

Close on an old recipe book that's also stuck to the board.

PIPI (O.S.)
Maybe the big book of whānau recipes!

PIPI (O.S.)
Pēhea oti te pīki puka tohutaka kai a te whānau!

Close on a picture of a pāua shell.

POTO (O.S.)
Maybe... the pāua shell he puts his keys in?

POTO (O.S.)
Aini pea... ko te anga pāua ka raua ai āna kī?

Close on Pipi’s face, eyes wide. *

PIPI
Yeah! Maybe he lost his keys! I got it Poto! There’s a map to some treasure inside the glovebox of his car!

PIPI
Āe hoki! Aini pea kua ngaro i a ia āna kī! Ah, kua mōhio e Poto! He mahere puipuiaki kei te pouaka karapu o tōna motokā!

POTO
Stop adding treasure to everything!

POTO
Kāti te kōrero puipuiaki e mara.

PIPI
(dramatic)
A taniwha--

PIPI
He taniwha hoki kei--

POTO
Stop adding a taniwha to everything too!

POTO
Kāti hoki te kōrero mō te taniwha!

PIPI
(holding up a comic)
Why not? Matua Mātai always follows wild leads. It’s how mysteries are solved!

PIPI
I te aha ai? Ka whai hoki a Matua Mātai I ngā tūwhai ara katoa. Koia ka kitea ai te mea ngaro!

We cut wide, the board is a cluttered mess. A jandal falls off the board and hits the floor.

They stare at it in silence, heads tilted in confusion. Pipi flops onto the floor in defeat.

PIPI
We’re getting nowhere Poto!

PIPI
Kua raru tāua e Poto!

Poto joins her.

POTO
Remember! Never giving up is...

POTO
Kia mahara! Kaua e mate wheke...

PIPI AND POTO
(reciting a quote)
“Still a step in the right direction.”

PIPI AND POTO
...me mate ururoa!

A push in on a faded Mātua Mātai poster, corners curled and yellowed, pinned to the wall. Mātua Mātai comes alive and winks at us. * * *

EXT. KORO'S GARDEN - DAY

Koro stumbles around the māra, muttering to himself and squinting at everything he picks up. Pipi and Poto, still distracted by their disagreement over the "mea," hardly notice. *

PIPI
(crosses her arms)
And I'm telling you, it's the hat. He says it's his lucky charm when he watches rugby!

PIPI
E ko tāku, ko tana pōtae. E ai ki a ia, ka mātakitaki whutupaoro ana ia, ko tana kura whakawhiwhi tērā!

In the background Koro Tama holds up a cabbage and squints at it.

PIPI
Fine. If you're so sure, let's split up and look for both!

PIPI
Kāti. Mehemea koia tērā, kia weherua tā tāua kimi...

POTO
(pointing)
Wait, what's Koro doing with that cabbage?

POTO
Taihoa, e aha kē ana Koro me te kāpeti rā?

A shaft of light beams down on Koro Tama and the cabbage. *

PIPI
Squinting… like Matua Mātai when he's missing his magnifying glass…

PIPI
E kikiwa mai ana... pērā ki a Matua Mātai, ka ngaro ana i a ia tāna kōata whakarahi...

Pipi thinks. Poto thinks. Something about this is familiar to both of them.

BEGIN FLASHBACK: *

Pipi enters the lounge, running up to Koro Tama. Tama doesn't have his glasses on. He squints.

KORO TAMA
Who's that there?

KORO TAMA
Ko wai tēnā?

From his POV we can't make out Pipi then... Pipi comes into focus.

KORO TAMA
Ahhh my moko.

KORO TAMA
Ahhh kia ora moko.

Koro goes in for a big hug.

END FLASHBACK: *

They look at each other, they've got it! Close on the two of them. *

PIPI AND POTO
His glasses!

PIPI AND POTO
Ōna mōwhiti!

PIPI
What did Koro do today?

PIPI
I aha a Koro I te rangi nei?

POTO
(thinking hard)
If we work out where he's been...

POTO
Ki te āta whai tāua I ōna tapuwae..

PIPI
(looking through magnifying glass)
Then we'll find them!

PIPI
Kāhore e kore ka kitea!

POTO
Then Koro can read us Matua Mātai!

POTO
Tahi a Koro ka pānuitia mai te paki o Matua Mātai!

INT. KORO'S GARDEN - PĀTAKA KAI / DETECTIVE ROOM - DAY

They think they finally have it. They've made a timeline of Koro's movements.

POTO
He woke up, then fell asleep again in the lounge.

POTO
I ara ake ia, tahi ka moe anō i te rūma noho.

PIPI
He made a tea.

PIPI
Ka panga kaputī mai.

POTO
Then when we went to Aunty's place to learn flax weaving, he went...

POTO
Kātahi, i a tāua ka haere ki te ako raranga i tō Whaea/ Aunty whare, ko ia ka...

They look at each other. They finally have it!

PIPI AND POTO
He went for a drive to get a punnet of Kina and a French stick.

PIPI AND POTO
Ka whiu waka ki te hoko kina me te parāoa.

INT. KORO'S CAR - DAY

Pipi and Poto enter the car and look everywhere.

Then they both see it... it's magnificent. The glasses are sitting in a cupholder.

PIPI AND POTO
We found it! Case closed!

PIPI AND POTO
Kua kitea! Tau kē!

DETECTIVE MODE DEACTIVATED *

POTO
Hmmm

PIPI
What?

POTO
I've got an idea.

POTO
Hmmm

PIPI
He aha e mara?

POTO
Taihoa, anei te whakaaro.

INT. KORO'S LOUNGE - DAY

Koro is asleep in his favourite armchair. Snoring loudly.

Pipi and Poto plop onto the rug at his feet, clutching the chosen comic: *The Kererū Clue*.

PIPI AND POTO
Koro!

PIPI AND POTO
Koro!

He awakens.

PIPI
We found your mea.

PIPI
Kua kitea tō mea!

KORO TAMA
Really moko?

KORO TAMA
Nē rā?

POTO
But we added an accessory so you can't lose it again.

POTO
Heoi, kua tāpirihia he mea anō kia kaua anō e ngaro i a koe.

Poto hands over a handcrafted harakeke neck strap for Koro's glasses.

KORO TAMA
This is awesome moko. Now my glasses have their own mea.

KORO TAMA
Hurō e moko! Kua whai mea hoki taku mea.

POTO
We made it!

POTO
Nā māua anō!

KORO TAMA
Now aren't you two, two clever detectives.

KORO TAMA
Koia kei a kōrua, e āku kairapu whakamīharo.

PIPI
Do you think Matua Mātai would hire us as his sidekicks?

PIPI
Ki ō whakaaro ka hiahiatia māua e Matua Mātai hei kaiāwhina?

KORO TAMA
He’d be lucky to have you two.

KORO TAMA
Mutunga mai e moko!

PIPI
Storytime now?

PIPI
Wā pānui pukapuka ināianei?

KORO TAMA
Sure is.

KORO TAMA
Āe hoki.

PIPI
No making up the ending this time though.

PIPI
Kia kaua hoki koe e hangahanga noa i tana mutunga.

POTO
And don’t fall asleep.

POTO
Kaua hoki e moe!

Ka kata rātou katoa.

THE END.